

Aspirin

(Bayer / Ecotrin / Bufferin / Anacin / Excedrin)

I. Classification

- Salicylate, non-steroidal anti-inflammatory

II. Action(s)

- Inhibits platelet aggregation
- Inhibits prostaglandin synthesis and effects hypothalamus, which produces anti-pyretic, non-opioid and non-steroidal anti-inflammatory and analgesic effects

III. Indication(s)

- Acute Myocardial Infarction
- Cardiac related chest pain, angina pectoris

IV. Contraindication(s)

- Hypersensitivity / allergy to aspirin
- Bleeding gastric or duodenal ulcers
- Hemophilia
- Thrombocytopenia (low platelet count)
- Children

V. Precautions

- NSAIDs may cause increase in gastric irritation
- May enhance the activity of anti-coagulant therapy

VI. Drug Interactions

- No drug interactions that should prevent administration when indicated

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 324 mg PO x 1 dose, chew before swallowing

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- Not given in pediatric EMS patients

IX. Onset

- 1 – 2 hours

X. Duration

- Half-life is approximately 6 hours

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Allergic reaction
- Bleeding
- Heartburn, Nausea/vomiting
- Drop in blood sugar levels (in diabetics)
- Kidney / liver toxicity